English for Career Development Syllabus

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Q3 2026

COURSE OVERVIEW

Description

English for Career Development is designed for high-beginner to low-intermediate non-native English speakers. This course guides learners through each step of the job application process while expanding their vocabulary and communication skills for professional contexts. You will global career opportunities, strengthen your language skills to achieve your professional goals.

- Module 1 Introduces the job application process and strategies for identifying your skills, interests, and job matches.
- Module 2 teaches how to write a clear, professional resume and adapt it for online applications, applicant tracking systems (ATS), and global contexts.
- Module 3 focuses on writing effective cover letters to present yourself professionally to employers.
- Module 4 develops your networking skills, helping you build professional relationships and connections.
- Module 5, the final module, prepares you for job interviews by practicing common questions, using the STAR method, managing interview stress and following up with thank-you letters.

This course was developed by the University of Pennsylvania and adapted by FHI 360 for the Online Professional English Network (OPEN), sponsored by the U.S. Department of State.

Dates:

This course will be active from **July 6** to **September 28, 2026**.

The course begins with an optional orientation module. This orientation is designed to help you get familiar with Canvas and how to get help. It is not mandatory.

Once you finish a module, the next one will automatically unlock. All coursework must be completed by **September 28, 2026** at 11:59 PM ET. No late submissions will be accepted.

Learning Objectives and Learner Outcomes

Career Development Objectives

1. Navigate the job search process by identifying your skills, interests, and professional goals.
2. Produce a professional resume that highlights education, experience, and skills, and adapt it for online applications and ATS.
3. Write clear and concise cover letters tailored to job postings.
4. Develop networking skills to build professional relationships online and in person.
5. Prepare for and succeed in job interviews, including using the STAR Method, managing stress, and writing a thank-you letter.

Language Learning Objectives

1. Expand your career-related vocabulary, including key words for resumes, cover letters, networking, and interviews.
2. Improve your grammar and writing fluency in professional contexts (e.g., action verbs in resumes, concise sentences in cover letters, correct verb tense in interviews).
3. Strengthen your listening and speaking skills for professional communication, including asking for clarification, responding briefly and clearly, and presenting yourself with confidence.
4. Use English to compare, contrast, and describe professional skills and experiences across different cultural and global contexts.

Career Skills Outcomes

- Create a personal job seeker profile that aligns with your career interests.
- Write a polished resume and cover letter that match job postings.
- Apply strategies for online applications, including effective use of keywords.
- Engage in networking activities and professional conversations with confidence.

- Prepare for and perform effectively in job interviews, and follow up with a professional thank-you letter.

Language Skills Outcomes

- Accurately use job-related vocabulary in resumes, cover letters, and interviews.
- Apply correct grammar and professional writing style in job search documents.
- Demonstrate improved oral communication skills in professional contexts.
- Discuss global career opportunities using clear, accurate English.

Expectations and Grading

Course Schedule: This course runs from **July 6** to **September 28, 2026.** In order to complete the course, participants should work online and offline for 3-5 hours per module. This is a self-paced course and assignments can be completed at any time. This is a self-paced course and assignments can be completed at any time before the close date on **September 28, 2026.**

How to pass this course: There are five modules in the English for Career Development MOOC:

1. Entering the Job Market
2. Writing a Resume
3. Writing a Cover Letter
4. Developing Your Professional Network
5. Interviewing for a Job

Each module will have one or more quizzes**. Participants who satisfactorily complete all of the required quizzes with a score of 70% or above before the course close date will receive a digital badge and certificate of participation.**

Along with graded quizzes, each module also has other opportunities to check your understanding and practice your language skills. These activities are labeled “OPTIONAL” in the course. These tasks are not graded nor required.

COURSE POLICIES

Plagiarism

Plagiarism is using someone else's words instead of your own. In this course, you are expected to use your own words and ideas, and to acknowledge any sources you use to gather ideas.

Acceptable Use of AI in OPEN Courses

Below, you can find the acceptable use guidance for AI in your OPEN course:

You may use AI tools to…	**You may *not* use AI tools to…**
Brainstorm ideas and approaches for completing an assignment	Generate ideas for an assignment that asks you to reflect on **your own experience**
Find research and paraphrase or summarize text to help you read or understand	Directly copy and paste AI-generated text into your assignment
Help generate an outline for your assignments	Generate a partial or complete assignment
Check your assignment's grammar or spelling so that you may correct errors before submission	Revise and edit your assignment for you

- If you use an AI tool to assist with an assignment, you should cite the AI tool you used and how you used it.
- You should not copy other participants' work into an AI tool.

In summary: AI tools can help you **brainstorm**, **research**, and **organize**, but they ***should not*** be used to **write** your assignments**.** For OPEN course assignments, you will be asked to reflect on topics and discuss your own personal teaching experiences. AI-generated assignments often focus on factual information, so they do not produce good answers to OPEN course prompts. Remember, OPEN course assignments are graded on their content, not on their level of English fluency or writing skill.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
Module 1, Entering the Job Market: • Use language to describe your professional interests and talents effectively, focusing on building a professional profile • Analyze and discuss trends in the global labor market • Recognize and explain the steps in the job search process, • Apply content-related vocabulary to practical job search activities • Use phrases for comparing and contrasting to discuss job search strategies across different cultures	**Review: Module 1 videos, presentations, and articles. (2 hours)** **Discuss: Join your colleagues in the following optional group discussions.** • Vision Board - Career Hopes and Dreams (30 minutes) • Building Self-Confidence with Positive Affirmations (30 minutes) • Written Comparison of the Job Search Process (30 minutes) • From Vision to Action: Setting Your Goal (30 minutes) **Check-In: Complete the following quizzes:** • Things, Actions, and People (20 minutes) • Simple Present vs. Present Progressive (20 minutes) • Key Words in a Job Advertisement (20 minutes)

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
Module 2, Writing a Resume: • Identify the key parts of a professional resume • Write clear, concise bullet points using action verbs • Understand how keywords affect ATS scans and resume success • Use AI tools to improve resume clarity while keeping your voice • Recognize how resume styles differ by region and company	**Watch, Read, and Learn:** • Watch the videos on resume structure, formatting, and keywords (30 - 60 minutes) • Read the articles on job ads, online applications, and using AI tools (2 hours) **Discuss: Join your colleagues in the following optional group discussion:** • Share Your Resume Progress (30 minutes) **Check Your Understanding:** • Quiz: Reading Job Ads (15 minutes) • Quiz: Describing Education, Experience, and Skills (15 minutes) • Quiz: Writing for Online Applications (15 minutes) • Quiz: Using AI To Improve Your Resume (15 minutes)

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
Module 3, Writing a Cover Letter: • Identify the structure and format of a professional cover letter • Use vocabulary common in job applications • Use past and present perfect tenses correctly • Use modal verbs to express politeness and confidence • Reflect on tone and audience across different communication styles • Use AI tools to improve your writing without losing your voice	**Review: Module 3 videos, presentations, and articles. (1 - 2 hours)** **Discuss: Optional: Join your colleagues in a group discussion on cover letters (60 minutes)** **Check-In: Complete the following activities:** • Match the Job Description with the Skills* (20 minutes) • Reading Practice: How Do I Write a Cover Letter (30 minutes) • Vocabulary Check: Letter Format* (20 minutes) • Grammar Review: Present Perfect vs Past Simple* (20 minutes) • Direct or Polite Language* (20 minutes) • Build Your Own Letter (20 minutes) • Module 3 Check* (5 minutes)

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
Module 4: Developing Your Professional Network • Recognize and use the language of networking and small talk • Identify and practice using stress, rhythm, and intonation to show meaning and emphasis as you deliver a brief networking elevator speech • Identify new fundamental vocabulary and use those new words and phrases in course activities • Introduce yourself briefly and clearly • Develop strategies for building and maintaining professional	**Review: Module 4 videos, presentations, and articles. (1 - 2 hours)** **Discuss: Optional: Join your colleagues in a discussion about networking elevator speeches (45 minutes)** **Check-In: Complete the following quizzes:** • Choose the Conversation with Appropriate Topics* (20 minutes) • Reading Practice: Networking During the Job Search (30 minutes) • Networking Vocabulary Matching* (20 minutes)

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
relationships in person and online • Request professional references effectively, including how and when to follow up • Navigate cultural norms related to networking and reference requests	
Module 5, Interviewing for a Job: • Identify different types of job interview questions and how to answer them • Use the STAR Method to answer behavioral questions with clear examples • Prepare, practice, and deliver short, confident interview responses	**Review: Module 5 videos, presentations, and articles. (1 - 2 hours)** **Discuss: Optional: Join your colleagues in an optional group discussion about interviews (30 minutes)** **Check-In: Complete the following quizzes:** • Reading Practice: Interview Tips (30 minutes) • Interview Jeopardy* (20 minutes) • Matching Answers to Questions* (20 minutes) • Quiz: Writing a Thank-You Letter (20 minutes) • Module 5 Check (5 minutes)

Module, Topic and Learning Objectives	Activities, Assignments, and Time Required
• Explore real-world advice from OPEN alumni about preparing for and managing interviews	